



Permissions: an octal representation

`chmod permissions file`

■ Read:	4	100
■ Read + Write:	6	110
■ Read + Execute:	5	101
■ Read + Write + Execute:	7	111
■ Write:	2	010
■ Write + Execute:	3	011
■ Execute:	1	001

A quick list of octal representation of different type of file permissions

shared permissions – any file in a group will give the same level of permissions to each and every user in that group. The final user type is Public, which is defined as not only any random user on the Internet, but anyone who's not an Owner or part of a Group policy for web server files.

If you're absolutely paranoid about your website's security, and you should be (why not?!), you can go ahead and deny permission to anyone but yourself (as the Owner of all files) access to your web server files. For anyone else that's not you, giving Read (4) level access should be fine, just to ensure that they don't make changes to it or execute it at all.

Server configuration lockdown

You can't call yourself a security-conscious webmaster if you haven't gotten your hands dirty at configuring critical web server files for your online website. For most of you who've tried your hand at hosting your own blog before on an easy-to-install Apache web server, that `.htaccess` file is the critical server configuration file. What's a `.htaccess` file, we hear you ask? Well, simply put, it's a plain text file that contains the directory level arrangement of all web server files and its associated access permissions. By rewriting or editing the `.htaccess` file, which usually sits in the root folder of the directory, you can essentially dictate access to different web directories under the tree, enforce password policies, 404 redirects, and more. Similar to Apache web server's